

Sensemaking

What are we going to do with all this information?

- **Review and Questions**
- **Lecture : Sensing**
- **Exercise**
- **Reflections**

Sensemaking is...



“

**...structuring the unknown so as to be able to
act on it.”**

Waterman

Sensemaking

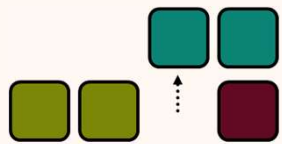


It is the process of “structuring the unknown” (Waterman, 1990, p. 41) by “placing stimuli into some kind of framework” that enables us “to comprehend, understand, explain, attribute, extrapolate, and predict” (Starbuck & Milliken, 1988, p. 51).

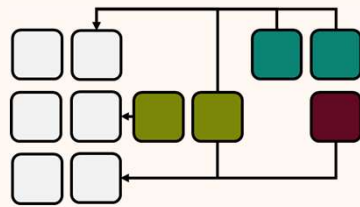
Sensemaking



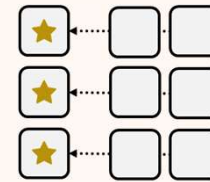
Involves four activities:



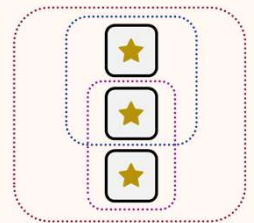
Organize Findings



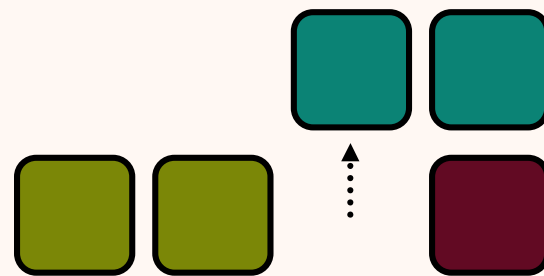
Find Themes



Identify Insights



Create Frames



Organize Findings

Sensemaking



One way to organize is by affinity.

Affinity Diagraming

⋮

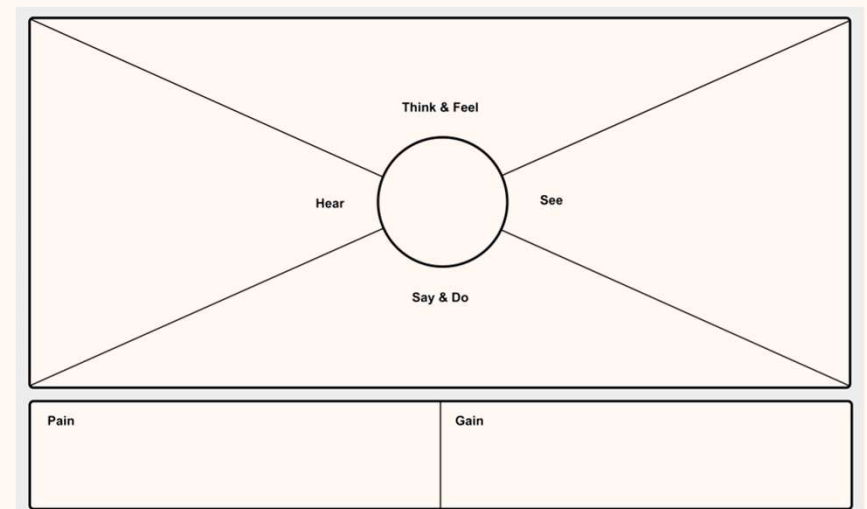


Sensemaking



Another is through the creation of artefacts:

Empathy Maps



Personas



LYNDA JACKSON

1.0 | Hypothetical



AGE
32

GENDER/IDENTITY
Woman

RACE/ETHNICITY
New Orleans

LOCATION
District Administrator

OCCUPATION
M.A. Education Policy

MARITAL/PARTNER STATUS
Single

FAMILY
Lives alone

HOMETOWN HERO

ABOUT LYNDA Lynda is from New Orleans – witnessing both the injustices and the resilience of her community during Katrina had a profound impact on her. She did the corps in New Orleans as a non-traditional Corps member; she's still in New Orleans but transitioned out of the classroom into school administration. She's passionate about education and is satisfied with the purpose in her work, but her present role isn't resonating with her personal goals.

LYNDA SAYS

Power to the people
cause the people have the power.

BEHAVIOURS

- Attends church and started social justice auxiliary.
- Is very community oriented and regularly attends community events; is well networked.
- Uses social to stay "plugged in".
- Mentors.
- Serves as an RST member with LEE.

ASPIRATIONS
+ GOALS

- Hopes to support/impact community in a *big* way.
- Aspires to be a decision-maker to support community.
- Values creating other leaders.

WANTS
+ NEEDS

- Needs to know how to get access to decisionmakers.
- Wants career coaching.
- Wants an outlet for creating impact in civic life.
- Needs a support system.

FRUSTRATIONS
+ PAIN POINTS

- Frustrated with complacency.
- Sees myriad injustices and worries that there's been little net improvement since she was a kid.

Unit 2 Module 1.2 • Lecture

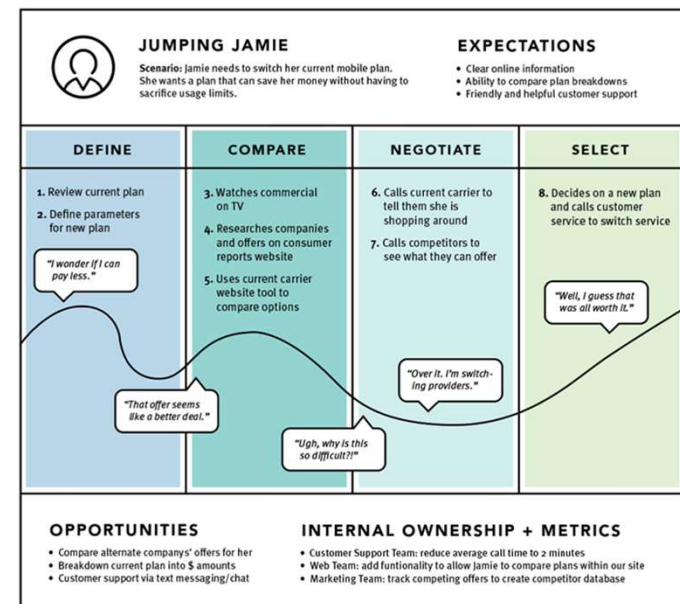
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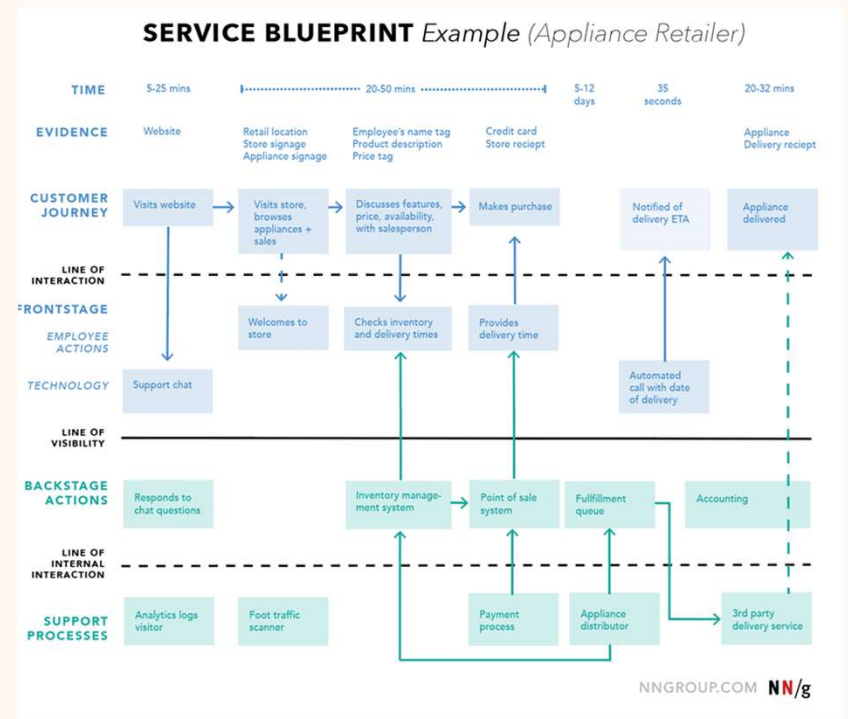
Journey Maps



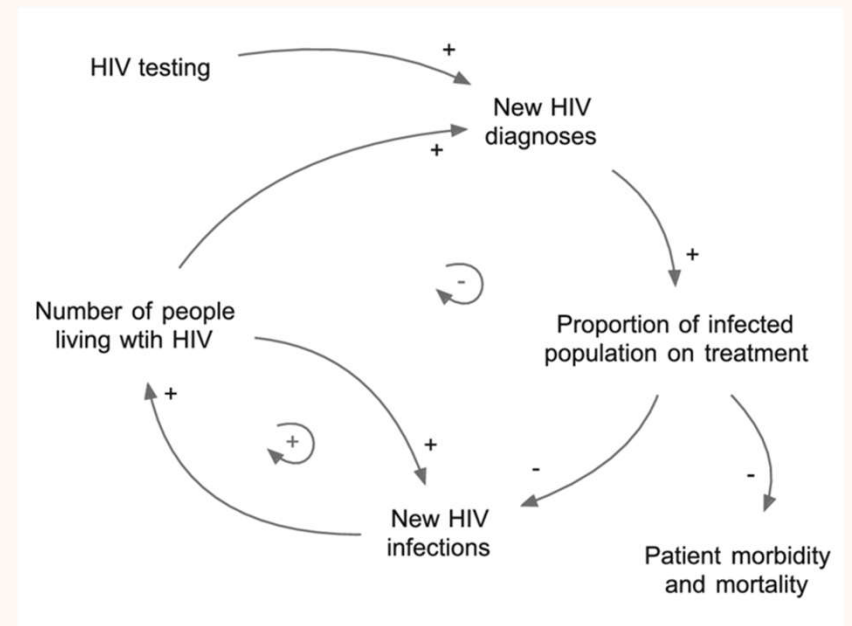
CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP Example (Switching Mobile Plans)



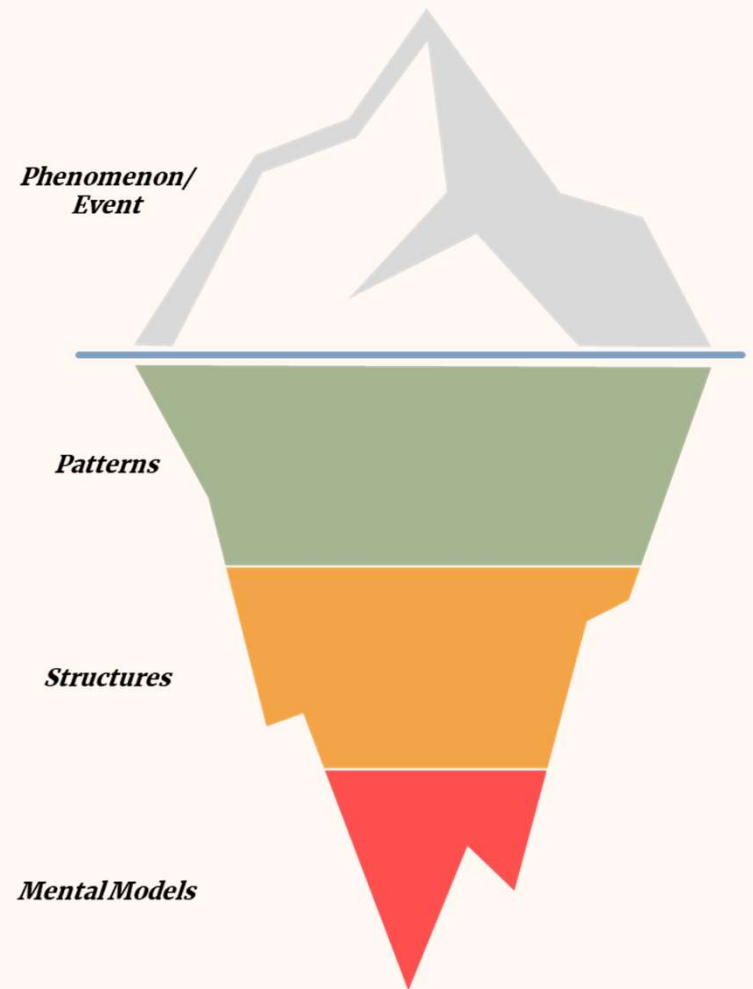
Service Blueprints

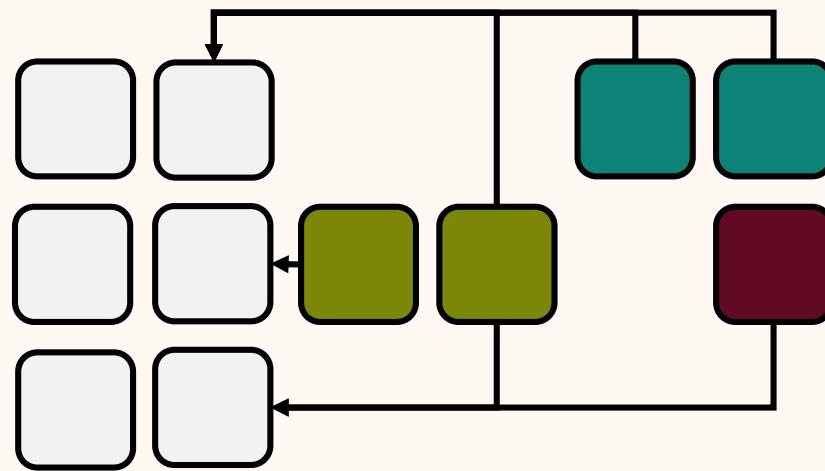


Causal Loop Diagrams



Iceberg Diagrams





Find Themes

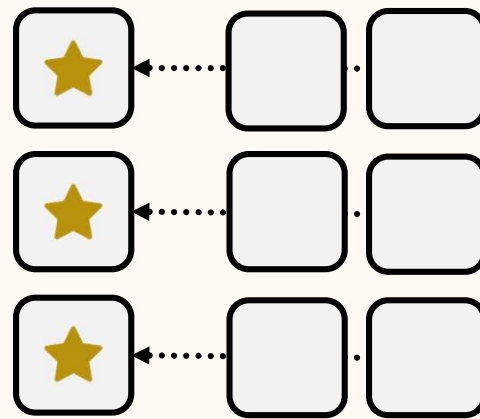
Themes

- Themes are patterns, often relating to the behaviours and experiences of actors and the needs and motivations expressed through those behaviours.

Coding



1	Interview 5 – Patient 5
2	
3	MC: Can you tell me how you feel about your experience of intensive care?
4	
5	Patient 5: Yes. I was admitted to hospital with a chest infection. It just got
6	worse and worse and I was struggling to breathe. I remember the doctor
7	coming to see me and I could tell she thought I was unwell. She stabbed me
8	in the wrist with a needle and then when she came back there seemed to be a
9	bit of a panic. I remember her explaining to me that I might need to go to
10	intensive care and I may end up on a ventilator, which I found really scary.
11	
12	MC: What did you find scary?
13	
14	Patient 5: It was that she would put me to sleep and I might not wake up.
15	
16	Red = Reason for admission
17	Yellow = Referral to ICU
18	Green = Patients perception of staff
19	Turquoise = Painful procedure
20	Blue = Treatment plan for admission and escalation
21	Pink = Patient expressing anxieties
22	



Identify Insights

1

Well-informed.

Is it informed by multiple data points—including secondary research, lived experience, and subject matter expertise?

2

More than an observation.

Does it offer insight into how or why a phenomenon is occurring?
Does it offer a compelling reframe of something we already know?

3

So what?

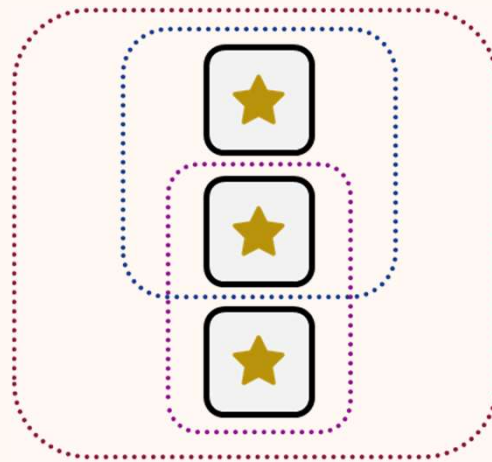
Does it help people understand why it matters? Does it capture a tension or a shift that needs to happen? Does it connect to project impact objectives and learning aims?

Design Opportunities

Generative insights

Design Principles/ Constraints

Evaluative insights.



Create Frames

Frames



Frames are thinking tools that act as lenses for explaining and interpreting the problem space.

Frames



Framing is about reflecting the facts of a problem, but doing so in a way that affords opportunity.

Frames

Frames follow a format:

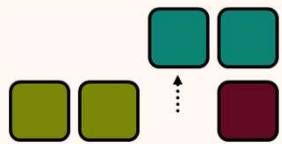


If the problem situation is approached as if it is...,
then....

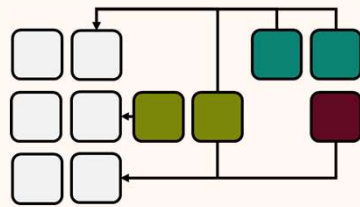
Exercise



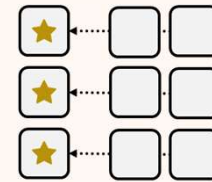
- **Head to** [Frame Creation and Design in the Expanded Field](#)
- **Read the case study p27** (*Italicized and beginning: “A brief example should help to explain the workings of this frame creation process:”*)
- **Discuss.** What are your thoughts on this approach? What does it make possible? What are its strengths? Shortcoming?



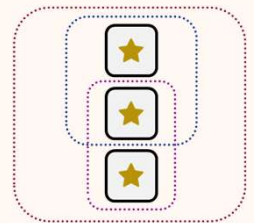
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